

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

SAVE 30%

AI Literacy • Complete Unit

THE WHOLE COURSE

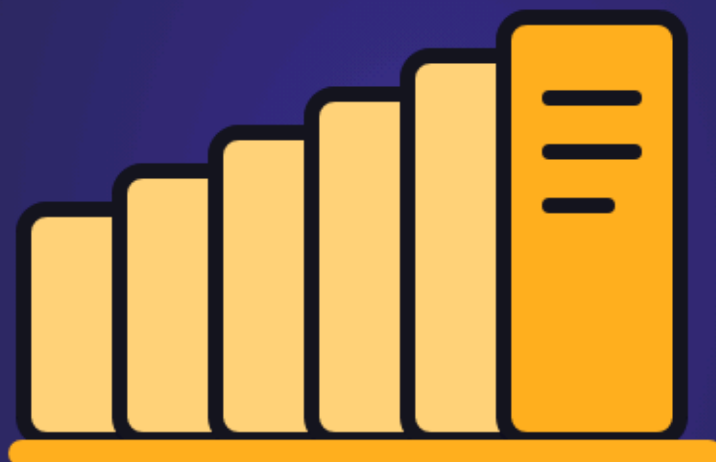
AI Literacy Unit

Every AI job starts
and ends with a human.

Grades 6–8

6 × 45-min lessons

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION • THE COMET

The Fact Desk



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

A note from Deja, the editor of The Comet, the school paper: "You're on the fact team. Three writers used an AI helper. Remember: AI guesses the most likely words — it does not check them — so it can be completely wrong and still sound sure. No story gets printed until you check it."

Desk words: run = it gets printed · clear = it passes the check · log = write it down · second source = a place to check that is NOT where you first saw the claim · "the ending still stands" = it is still true once the facts are fixed · stamp = your verdict box (RUN, FIX, or KILL) — check one · column = one writer's regular story

Your method, every draft:

- 1. **UNDERLINE** every checkable claim (names, dates, numbers, places, quotes).
- 2. **RANK** — write **C** above claims to CHECK, **S** above SAFE ones.
- 3. **LATERAL-READ** — leave the draft. Log a second source that could confirm each C.
- 4. **VERDICT** — check a stamp, give your evidence, and say if the writer's ending still stands.

On the typeable PDF you can't underline. Copy each claim you'd CHECK into the table, and put your S-claims in the last row.

🔍 DRAFT #1 — PRIYA'S SCIENCE COLUMN, "MOON FACTS"

The Moon is Earth's only natural satellite. Astronauts first landed on the Moon in 1959, and Neil Armstrong was the first person to walk on its surface. By 1972, twelve people had walked on the Moon. On a clear night the Moon seems to shine because it produces its own light — which is why it's the brightest thing in the night sky.

Log your two riskiest claims — the two that would hurt The Comet most if they are wrong.

CLAIM I MARKED C (CHECK)		SECOND SOURCE: WHERE I'D CHECK IT	

☐ RUN — clean, print it	☐ FIX — correct it, then print	☐ KILL — cut the story
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Note to Priya — what's wrong, your second source, and does her ending still stand?

Need a start? What's wrong: _____. I would check _____.

THE LITERAL GENIE LESSON • LESSON 1 OF 6

How to Talk to AI



45 minutes, no prep. The hook: AI is a literal genie — it grants what you SAID, not what you MEANT. Students learn both human jobs in every AI task: the prompt and the check. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Cursed Wish Repair Shop worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; typeable PDF included) · Slides (optional) · board for P.R.O. · Teacher Guide (Scoring Guidance, P.R.O. sentence starters) · pens	None — runs fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides; one AI tool (ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini) on your screen for the Showcase.	Print worksheets (and Teacher Guide p.3 if you use the Support/ELL sentence starters). That's it.

OBJECTIVES

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.3.b

CCSS ELA W.6.4

- Show how a vague prompt lets the genie choose (and why that produces a worse answer). (*Exit Ticket #1, part two*)
- Apply **P.R.O.** (Purpose, Requirements, Output) to write a clear prompt. (*Wish repairs 1–3; Exit Ticket #1*)
- Evaluate a sample AI answer: find the checkable claim and where to check it. (*Exit Ticket #2*)

♦ WARM-UP — THE WORST GENIE EVER (8 MIN)

You are a genie who grants wishes *exactly as worded*. Take 3–4 wishes and ruin every one, cheerfully:

"I wish I was rich." → "Done. Your name is now Rich."
 "I wish for a million dollars." → "Granted: one million dollars, in play money."
 "I wish school was over." → "Granted: The school building is now over... there."

Then ask: "**Whose fault was that — the genie's, or the wish's?**" **Bridge:** "AI works like that genie. It doesn't know what you MEANT — it only knows what you SAID. Every AI job goes human, AI, human: you start it with the wish, the genie does the middle, and you check what comes back. Today you get good at both human parts."

What if a wish is inappropriate? Don't play it: "The genie doesn't grant that one. Next wish." Nobody volunteers? Wish first yourself: "I wish for a snack" → "Granted: one grain of rice."

Transition: "So how do you write a wish a genie can't twist? Lawyers figured this out a long time ago."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — PARTS OF A GENIE-PROOF WISH (10 MIN)

Lawyers make contracts genie-proof with clauses. Strong prompts have three parts — write **P.R.O.** on the board as you go:

P — Purpose. What you want + who it's for. "Explain photosynthesis to a 6th grader" beats "explain photosynthesis."

R — Requirements. The rules: length, tone, format, include / leave out. This is what stops the twist.

O — Output. What should the finished answer look like? A list? A paragraph? A table? A plan?

Watch one get fixed — build the repair on the board, naming each part as you add it. **Cursed wish:** "help with my history essay" → **Genie-proof P.R.O. prompt:** "I'm writing a 7th grade history essay on the printing press. Give me 3 thesis statements and 2 pieces of evidence for each, as a bullet list. Don't write it for me." With devices: run it live.

◆ THE AI-HONESTY DISCUSSION (USE ANYTIME IT COMES UP)

Q: "Is using AI cheating?" — One sentence settles it: *AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter.* Feedback, brainstorming, checking understanding = editor. Handing in its work with your name on it = ghostwriter, and a wish you never earned. Ask: "What did YOU make?"

Q: "Is the AI always right?" — No. It predicts likely words; it can be confidently wrong ("hallucinate") — a trickster genie. Rule of thumb: anything that's a checkable fact (dates, numbers, names, quotes) gets checked against a real source before you use it.

Q: "Will AI take all the jobs?" — The honest answer: nobody knows, and say so. So far the clearest cases are tasks inside jobs, not whole jobs — nobody can promise the final count. A person who can direct an AI clearly and check what it hands back likely has an edge — and that is today's lesson.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: P.R.O. instruction (a prompt broken into Purpose / Requirements / Output). Assessed: the three wish repairs (worksheet p.1) and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the Scoring Guidance above.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: the trickster rule that opens the Exit Ticket block and the "Is the AI always right?" discussion. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 — students evaluate a printed sample AI answer, find the checkable claim and name where they would verify it.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: the Purpose part (task + audience) and the Requirements part (style, length, tone). Assessed: wish repairs 1–3 + Exit Ticket #1.*

SUPPORT & ELL: P.R.O. SENTENCE STARTERS

P: "I am a ____ grader working on _____. I want ____ for _____."

R: "Keep it ____ (length). Use a ____ tone. Include _____. Do NOT _____."

O: "Give me the answer as a ____ (list / table / paragraph / steps)."

Support students may repair two wishes instead of three. ELL students may draft in their strongest language first, then translate — the starters double as language frames.

◆ THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

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UNIT OVERVIEW & PACING GUIDE

AI Literacy Unit



Six 45-minute lessons. No prep, no devices required. Teach them in order for the full arc, or pull any single lesson — each one stands alone.

◆ THE UNIT AT A GLANCE

#	LESSON	STUDENTS LEARN TO...	THE HOOK
1	How to Talk to AI	Write prompts a literal AI can't twist (P.R.O.)	AI is a literal genie
2	What's in the Playlist?	Explain how AI learns; find bias in a dataset	Training data is a playlist
3	Hallucination Hunters	Fact-check AI output; lateral-read claims	A newsroom fact desk
4	Teach AI Your Taste	Use AI for feedback, then revise their own work	Your For-You Page
5	Robots Do the Boring Work	Argue automation tradeoffs; think about future jobs	A studio task board
6	Lead Your AI Squad	Brief a team, assign roles, check the work (capstone)	You're the party leader

◆ THE THROUGH-LINE

Human → AI → Human. Every AI job has two human parts: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). Those two jobs are the whole skill, and they transfer to every AI tool your students will ever touch. Lesson 1 trains the start; Lesson 3 trains the check; Lessons 2, 4, 5 and 6 each show where the human at each end has to step in — the gap in the playlist, the taste file you hand over, the call only a person makes, the loot only the leader checks.

The honesty policy in one sentence students remember: AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter.

◆ PACING OPTIONS

IF YOU HAVE...	DO THIS
Six class periods	One lesson per day, in order. The capstone lands on day 6.
Six weeks (one period/week)	One lesson per week. Open each with a 2-minute recall: "what were the two human jobs?"
Three block periods	Pair them: 1+2 (how to talk to it / how it thinks), 3+4 (check it / shape it), 5+6 (decide what it does / lead it).
One period, ever	Lesson 1 alone delivers the highest-value skill. Lesson 3 if your focus is media literacy.
A sub tomorrow	Lesson 3 — the sub reads a paragraph aloud, calls a vote, and hands out the fact desk. Zero devices, zero prep.

FULL DOWNLOAD: 6 LESSONS • 31 FILES